

Stop Mice Coming Back Guide — Action Checklist

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FOUNDATION & GARAGE SEALING

- **Foundation & Garage Sealing, Inspect where your foundation meets the sill plate at corners and where water pipes, gas lines, or electrical conduits penetrate the foundation wall for dime-sized gaps that mice exploit. Foundation & Garage Sealing, Check the corners of your garage door frame where it meets the concrete floor, as this is one of the most commonly missed entry points in most homes. Foundation & Garage Sealing, Seal gaps around your automatic garage door opener's wire conduit and examine the overhead garage door torsion spring cover for any openings a mouse could squeeze through. Foundation & Garage Sealing, Inspect spaces where your garage interior walls meet the garage floor and where the garage connects to your living space, as mice travel through these gaps regularly. Interior Entry Points, Inspect behind kitchen appliances including the refrigerator, stove, and dishwasher where pipes and wires enter the wall for any gaps approximately 1/4 inch or wider. Interior Entry Points, Examine dryer vent gaps where the flex duct connects to the vent hood and bathroom exhaust fan openings for large gaps between the fan housing and the ceiling. Interior Entry Points, Check basement floor drains for broken covers and inspect around water heater and furnace intake or exhaust pipes where they penetrate basement walls. Interior Entry Points, Inspect worn or missing door sweeps on exterior doors and gaps in weather stripping at the bottom of exterior doors, as these allow mice immediate access at ground level. Active Gap Assessment, Mark every gap you find with painter's tape and measure each one later, because your inspection goal is identifying all openings regardless of initial apparent size. Active Gap Assessment, Use your flashlight to identify fresh mouse droppings near each gap, since fresh droppings that are dark, moist, and rice-grain shaped indicate an active entry point. Active Gap Assessment, Look for urine pillars near gaps, which are hardened mounds of dried mouse urine that take time to form and indicate a well-established mouse highway. Active Gap Assessment, Identify rub marks along baseboards and wall edges where mice follow walls consistently, as these dark smudges reveal their regular travel routes and active pathways.:**

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❑ **Check the Full Guide:** This step is described in detail in the companion guide — open stop-mice-coming-back-guide_v1.md and review the relevant section.

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INTERIOR ENTRY POINTS

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ACTIVE GAP ASSESSMENT

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